Title of the thesis:
and its sub-title

Full Name

Faculty of Life and Health Sciences of Ulster University

Thesis submitted for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy

Month Year

I confirm that the word count of this thesis is less than 100,000 words excluding the title page, contents, acknowledgements, summary or abstract, abbreviations, footnotes, diagrams, maps, illustrations, tables, appendices, and references or bibliography.

Abstract

Write the abstract here.

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Abbreviations

GIS geographic information system.

PRISMA Preferred Reporting Items for Systematic Reviews and Meta-Analyses.

Acknowledgements

Write the acknowledgements here.

Declaration on the use of generative artificial intelligence

This declaration follows the Ulster University Doctoral College guidance on the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools. The use described here was agreed with the supervisory team on [date].

Tools. [Name and version of each tool, and the period of use.]

Purposes. [For example: code assistance; checking references; language editing; drafting of specified sections, which were checked and revised by the candidate.]

Not delegated. [For example: the research questions, design, analysis, interpretation and conclusions.]

Responsibility. The candidate takes full responsibility for the content of this thesis.

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background

Text with a citation in Harvard style (Page et al. 2021), or naming the authors, as Roberts et al. (2017) show. Cross-references are written with `\cref`: Chapter 3, Table 4.1, Figure 4.1 and Appendix A.

1.2 Aim, objectives and research questions

O1. First objective.

O2. Second objective.

1.3 Structure of the thesis

Chapter 2 reviews the literature, Chapter 3 describes the methods, Chapter 4 presents the results, Chapter 5 discusses them and Chapter 6 concludes.

Chapter 2

Literature review

2.1 Review method

For a systematic review, report the methods following PRISMA 2020 (Page et al. 2021).

Chapter 3

Methods

3.1 Data

Equations are numbered by chapter:

$$\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i. \tag{3.1}$$

3.2 Validation

Describe how results are validated, for example with spatially separated test data (Roberts et al. 2017).

Chapter 4

Results

4.1 Main results

Tables have their title above (Ulster), figures their caption below.

Table 4.1: An example table (title above the table).

Group	Mean	SD
A	1.20	0.30
B	1.45	0.28

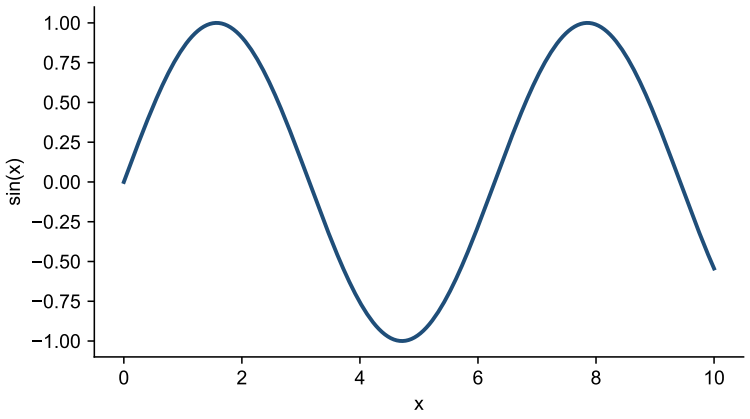


Figure 4.1: An example figure (caption below the figure).

Chapter 5

Discussion

5.1 Principal findings

Discuss the findings.

5.2 Limitations

State the limitations.

Chapter 6

Conclusions

Conclude, and give recommendations and future work.

Appendix A

Supplementary material

Supplementary tables, code descriptions or data registers.

References

Page, M. J., McKenzie, J. E., Bossuyt, P. M., Boutron, I., Hoffmann, T. C., Mulrow, C. D., Shamseer, L., Tetzlaff, J. M., Akl, E. A., Brennan, S. E., Chou, R., Glanville, J., Grimshaw, J. M., Hróbjartsson, A., Lalu, M. M., Li, T., Loder, E. W., Mayo-Wilson, E., McDonald, S., McGuinness, L. A., Stewart, L. A., Thomas, J., Tricco, A. C., Welch, V. A., Whiting, P. and Moher, D. (2021), 'The prisma 2020 statement: an updated guideline for reporting systematic reviews', *BMJ* p. n71.

Roberts, D. R., Bahn, V., Ciuti, S., Boyce, M. S., Elith, J., Guillera-Arroita, G., Hauenstein, S., Lahoz-Monfort, J. J., Schröder, B., Thuiller, W., Warton, D. I., Wintle, B. A., Hartig, F. and Dormann, C. F. (2017), 'Cross-validation strategies for data with temporal, spatial, hierarchical, or phylogenetic structure', *Ecography* **40**(8), 913–929.